

didn't really think about this decision that hard. Maybe I should have. If you want to do something similar, I'd do more research than I did. Are these photographers reputable? What's the right rate to charge? Should I let someone I trust know where I'm going in case shit goes down? (Yes, absolutely. And give a time you're expected to be done so if you're not picking up your phone by then, they can call 911.) Make sure you know you're like me and you won't be bothered by the photos later, or that modeling won't come back to bite you in the ass (pun intended) job-wise or family-wise. (Like my manager, my parents have given up at this point.)

Right as I was getting into this modeling thing, a man who worked at Nickelodeon and had been a fan of my *100 Interviews* blog reached out and asked if I wanted to work in a writers' room for a children's sketch comedy show. My 2011 post on *100 Interviews* looking for people to hire me had paid off three years later.

Right after this writer's room ended, someone else who had enjoyed *100 Interviews* emailed me to ask if I'd want to do a six-week residency at BuzzFeed Video. I parlayed that into a full-time writing gig in its video department. My salary was \$55,000 a year. My BFF Allison and I already had our own comedy YouTube channel, *Just Between Us*, with a small 5,000-fan subscriber base. I'd met Allison soon after I moved to Los Angeles at a stand-up-comedy open mic.

One day, one of the video producers at BuzzFeed was looking for two female best friends to star in a video they called *If Girl Best Friends Acted Like Guy Best Friends*. He asked me if I'd want to be in it and if I had a real-life best friend. BOY, DID I! Allison and I starred in that video together, and from there, she was also hired at BuzzFeed.

The downside to a job like this is that when you create for a media company, often that company owns all your work. When you leave, you have to start from scratch. But by the time we were ready to leave BuzzFeed in 2015, we'd grown our own channel and actually had intellectual property that we owned with our side project, *Just Between Us* (JBU).

After we quit, I got by on the JBU channel and some sporadic acting and writing work. The channel got a few branded deals where we shilled for companies for anywhere from \$1,000 to \$5,000, income that Allison and I split.